IELTS SPEAKING • TOPIC 16

ADAPTING TO SOMETHING NEW

Natural collocations • Advanced grammar structures • Sample answer

PART 1 • QUESTIONS

- Do you like routines?
- How do you feel when plans suddenly change?
- Have you ever moved to a new place?

PART 2 • CUE CARD

Describe a time you had to adapt to something new.

You should say:

- what it was
- why you had to adapt
- what was difficult
- how you coped

PART 3 • QUESTIONS

- What helps people adapt to new situations?
- Is it harder for older people to adapt?
- How can companies help employees adjust to new technology?

50	12	62	124
collocations	structures	Band 8 stories	your sentences

START HERE

One plan for every “adapting to something new” card

A time you moved to a new place

A time you started a new school or job

A time you learned a new skill

A change in your life you had to accept

A time you used new technology

A time you travelled to a very different place

A rule or routine you found hard to follow

A time you had to adapt to a change of plan

What the new thing → **Why** you had to adapt → **Hard** what was difficult → **How** you coped and what you learned

HOW TO READ EACH CARD

Tarjima + definition — o‘zbekcha ma’nosi va oddiy inglizcha izohi.

Band 8 story — iborani ro‘yxat emas, mini hikoya ichida ishlatish namunasi.

≈ Yaqin iboralar — shu ma’noga yaqin yana 2 ta natural ibora.

Qachon ishlatiladi — qaysi vaziyatda va qanday grammatika bilan.

Namuna gap — bitta tayyor gap. Keyin o‘zingiz 2 ta gap yozing.

Speaking ball — shu ibora gapirishda qanchalik foydali (10 dan).

10 / 10	Signature ibora: Band 8 ni ko‘rsatadi, ko‘p topiclarda ishlaydi.
8–9	Kuchli va moslashuvchan: tabiiy eshitiladi, ball oshiradi.
6–7	Foydali va ishonchli: asos sifatida yaxshi.
4–5	Vaziyatga bog‘liq yoki oddiyroq: faqat mos kelganda ishlating.

Facing something new

COLLOCATIONS 1 / 5

1 be thrown in at the deep end

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

to‘satdan chuqur joyga tashlanmoq, tajribasiz holda qiyin ishga kirishmoq • *to be given a hard task with no preparation or experience*

BAND 8 STORY

On my first day at the call centre I **was thrown in at the deep end** and had to answer angry customers alone. My hands were shaking, but by Friday I’d handled forty calls and felt oddly proud.

≈ **be dropped in it** — qiyin ahvolga tushib qolmoq

≈ **sink or swim** — yo‘q bo‘lasan yoki o‘rganasan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi ish yoki vaziyatda tayyorgarliksiz boshlaganingizni aytganda ishlating: be thrown in at the deep end (passiv). Part 2 hikoyasining boshlanishiga juda mos.

Namuna gap: When I moved abroad, I **was thrown in at the deep end** because nobody explained how anything worked.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 step out of your comfort zone

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

qulaylik doirasidan chiqmoq • *to try something new that feels uncomfortable or scary*

BAND 8 STORY

I’m quite shy, so joining the university debate club meant I had to **step out of my comfort zone**. My voice trembled in the first round, yet I walked home grinning because I’d actually done it.

≈ **push yourself** — o‘zini majburlamoq, zo‘riqtirmoq

≈ **venture out of your shell** — o‘z chig‘anog‘idan chiqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 1 va 3 da ham ishlatiladi: step out of one’s comfort zone. Ko‘pincha ‘force myself to‘ yoki ‘learn to‘ bilan keladi. Juda keng tarqalgan, lekin ortiqcha takrorlamang.

Namuna gap: Studying abroad forced me to **step out of my comfort zone** and talk to complete strangers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 take the plunge

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

jur’at qilib qaror qilmoq, tavakkal qilmoq • *to finally decide to do something big after thinking about it*

BAND 8 STORY

I’d wanted to change my major for months but kept hesitating. In the end I **took the plunge**, transferred to IT, and it was the scariest and best decision of my life.

≈ **make the leap** — katta qadam tashlamoq

≈ **bite the bullet** — qiyin qarorni qabul qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Katta qaror (ko‘chish, ish almashtirish) haqida gapirganda: take the plunge. Odatda uzoq o‘ylanishdan keyingi qarorni bildiradi, kichik ishlar uchun emas.

Namuna gap: After years of dreaming, she finally **took the plunge** and moved to Tashkent on her own.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 a steep learning curve

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

juda tez va qiyin o‘rganish davri • *a period when you must learn a lot very quickly*

BAND 8 STORY

My first month using a new accounting program was **a steep learning curve**. I stayed late every evening watching tutorials, but by week four I was teaching a colleague the shortcuts.

≈ **a baptism of fire** — og‘ir sinov, olovda cho‘qintirish

≈ **a crash course** — tezlashtirilgan kurs

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi texnologiya, ish yoki fan haqida: face / go through / be on a steep learning curve. Ijobiy ma’noda ham ishlatiladi: ‘qiyin edi, lekin ko‘p o‘rgandim’.

Namuna gap: Using the new software was **a steep learning curve**, but it taught me to be patient.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 culture shock

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

madaniy shok • *the confusion you feel in a country or place with very different customs*

BAND 8 STORY

When my cousin arrived in Seoul, the speed of daily life gave her real **culture shock**. Nobody greeted strangers and the subway was silent, so she felt lonely until she found a small Uzbek café.

≈ **cultural disorientation** — madaniy chalkashlik

≈ **a clash of cultures** — madaniyatlar to‘qnashuvi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Chet elga yoki boshqa muhitga o‘tganda: experience / suffer from / get over culture shock. ‘a culture shock’ emas, odatda artiklsiz ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: I got **culture shock** on my first visit to Istanbul because the pace was so different from home.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 start from scratch

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

noldan boshlamoq • *to begin something again from the very beginning, with nothing*

BAND 8 STORY

When my family moved to Tashkent, we had to **start from scratch**. New school, new neighbours, not a single friend. It was tiring, but I slowly built a small circle of friends I still trust.

≈ **start afresh** — yangidan boshlamoq

≈ **build from the ground up** — poydevordan qurmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(oshpazlik) tayyor yarim mahsulotsiz, noldan tayyorlamoq — I cook plov **from scratch** because the packaged mixes just don’t taste the same.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi hayot, ish yoki biznesni noldan boshlaganda: start (all over) from scratch. Shuningdek ‘cook from scratch’ (tayyor mahsulotsiz pishirish) ma’nosi bor.

Namuna gap: Moving to another city meant I had to **start from scratch** and make new friends.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 feel like a fish out of water

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini suvdan chiqqan baliqdek his qilmoq • *to feel uncomfortable because the surroundings are unfamiliar*

BAND 8 STORY

At my first office party I **felt like a fish out of water**. Everyone else knew each other and joked about things I didn’t understand, so I smiled and nodded until a kind colleague pulled me into the conversation.

≈ **feel out of my depth** — qo‘lidan kelmayotgandek his qilmoq

≈ **feel like an outsider** — o‘zini begonadek his qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: be / feel like a fish out of water. Notanish jamoa yoki muhitda noqulaylikni tasvirlash uchun; Part 2 da hissiyotni ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: Arriving in the big city, I **felt like a fish out of water** among so many fast-walking strangers.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 uncharted territory

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

notanish, hali o‘rganilmagan soha • *a situation or place that is completely new and unknown*

BAND 8 STORY

Becoming a manager at twenty-four was **uncharted territory** for me. There was no handbook and nobody my age to ask, so I learned by trial and error and a lot of coffee.

≈ **new ground** — yangi yo‘nalish

≈ **unfamiliar ground** — notanish zamin

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hayotda yoki ishda mutlaqo yangi vaziyat haqida: enter / venture into uncharted territory. Biroz rasmiy-adabiy, shuning uchun Part 2 va 3 uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: For my parents, online banking was **uncharted territory**, so I sat with them and showed every step.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 a daunting prospect

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qo‘rqituvchi, ko‘ngilni xira qiladigan istiqbol • *something in the future that feels frightening because it is so big or hard*

BAND 8 STORY

Living alone in a foreign country was **a daunting prospect** at eighteen. I made a checklist of tiny tasks, like buying a SIM card, and ticking them off made the big picture feel manageable.

≈ **an intimidating thought** — qo‘rqituvchi o‘y

≈ **a scary thought** — qo‘rqinchli fikr

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘be a daunting prospect’ yoki ‘face a daunting prospect’ shaklida. Kelajak haqidagi qo‘rquvni bildiradi, o‘tmish uchun ‘it seemed daunting‘ ham mumkin.

Namuna gap: Speaking English in front of a class was **a daunting prospect** until my teacher made it fun.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 turn over a new leaf

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

yangi sahifa ochmoq, o‘zini tuzatib yangidan boshlamoq • *to start behaving in a better way or begin a fresh chapter in life*

BAND 8 STORY

After failing my first-year exams I decided to **turn over a new leaf**. I switched off my phone at night, planned every week, and by spring my grades had climbed back up.

≈ **start afresh** — yangidan boshlamoq

≈ **make a fresh start** — yangi boshlanish qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Odatlarni o‘zgartirish haqida: decide to / promise to turn over a new leaf. Faqat ijobiy o‘zgarish uchun, joy almashtirishda emas.

Namuna gap: Moving to a new school was my chance to **turn over a new leaf** and finally become organised.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 feel overwhelmed

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini bosilib qolgandek, boshi qotgandek his qilmoq • *to feel that there is too much to deal with at once*

BAND 8 STORY
In my first week at university I **felt overwhelmed**. Timetables, new rooms, strange accents everywhere. I sat on a bench and almost cried, then a classmate offered to show me the library.

≈ **feel swamped** — ishdan bo‘g‘ilib qolgandek his qilmoq

≈ **feel snowed under** — ish ostida qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ko‘p vazifa yoki yangi ma’lumotdan charchashni ifodalaydi: feel overwhelmed + by/with + ot. Part 2 da ‘what was difficult’ bandiga juda mos.

Namuna gap: I **felt overwhelmed** by the sheer amount of new vocabulary during my first month in London.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 take its toll on

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ga salbiy ta’sir qilmoq, charchatmoq • *to have a bad effect on someone’s health or mood over time*

BAND 8 STORY
Working night shifts while learning a new job **took its toll on** me. I was always exhausted and snapped at my friends, so I finally spoke to my manager and changed my schedule.

≈ **wear someone down** — kimnidir toliqtirmoq

≈ **have an effect on** — ta’sir qilmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uzoq muddatli stress yoki charchoq haqida: X takes its toll on + odam/salomatlik. ‘Toll’ dan keyin ‘on’ kerak; X ko‘pincha vaqt, ish yoki stress bo‘ladi.

Namuna gap: The constant pressure of adjusting to city life began to **take its toll on** my sleep.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

13 struggle to keep up

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ulgurishga qiynalmoq, qolib ketmaslikka urinmoq • *to find it hard to stay at the same level or speed as others*

BAND 8 STORY
In my first semester abroad I **struggled to keep up** with lectures delivered at lightning speed. I recorded every class and listened again at home, which slowly turned the confusion into confidence.

≈ **fall behind** — ortda qolmoq

≈ **find it hard to cope** — uddalashga qiynalmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: ‘struggle to + fe’l’ yoki ‘struggle with + ot’. Keep up with + ot (the lessons / the pace / the workload) ham ishlatiladi. ‘very’ qo‘shish shart emas.

Namuna gap: At first I **struggled to keep up** with my colleagues, who all seemed so experienced.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

14 get homesick

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

uyni qattiq sog‘inmoq • *to feel sad because you miss your home and family*

BAND 8 STORY

During my first winter in the dormitory I **got** terribly **homesick**. I missed my mother’s soup so much that I called her every evening, and she would stay on the line while I cooked.

≈ **miss home** — uyni sog‘inmoq

≈ **long for home** — uyni intiqlik bilan sog‘inmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uydan uzoqda bo‘lganda: get / feel homesick; ‘homesick for home’ demang, shunchaki ‘homesick’. Hissiyotni tasvirlashda Part 2 uchun juda foydali.

Namuna gap: I **got homesick** the moment the train left Samarkand station.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

15 language barrier

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

til to‘sig‘i • *a difficulty in communicating because people speak different languages*

BAND 8 STORY

The **language barrier** was my biggest problem in Berlin. I could order food, but I couldn’t explain a simple problem to my landlord, so I started a notebook of useful phrases that I practised on the bus.

≈ **communication gap** — muloqotdagi bo‘shliq

≈ **lost in translation** — tarjimada yo‘qolgan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Chet elda yoki xorijiy jamoada: overcome / break down / face a language barrier. ‘language problem’ o‘rniga shu ibora ancha tabiiy.

Namuna gap: Gestures and smiles helped me overcome the **language barrier** on my first trip to China.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

16 hit a rough patch

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

qiyin davrni boshdan kechirmoq • *to go through a difficult period for a while*

BAND 8 STORY

About two months after I started my new job, I **hit a rough patch**. I made silly mistakes and doubted myself, but my supervisor reminded me that everyone struggles at first, and that helped.

≈ **go through a bad patch** — yomon davr

≈ **have a tough time** — qiyin paytni boshdan kechirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Vaqtinchalik qiyinchilik haqida: hit / go through a rough patch. Davr o‘tib ketishini nazarda tutadi, shuning uchun optimistik tugatish yaxshi.

Namuna gap: I **hit a rough patch** in the second month, but it passed once I made some friends.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

17 bite off more than I can chew

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

kuchim yetmaydigan ishga qo‘l urmoq • *to take on a task that is too big for you to manage*

BAND 8 STORY
When I started evening classes while working full-time, I **bit off more than I could chew**. I was falling asleep in lessons, so I dropped one subject and finally found a balance I could live with.

≈ **take on too much** — haddan ortiq ish olmoq

≈ **overstretch myself** — kuchimdan ortiq zo‘riqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom, o‘tgan zamonda ko‘p: I bit off more than I could chew. O‘z xatoingizni tan olishda ishlating; ijobiy emas, shuning uchun hikoyada burilish nuqtasi bo‘ladi.

Namuna gap: I **bit off more than I could chew** by joining three clubs in my first week.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

18 feel out of place

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini begonadek, joyida emasdek his qilmoq • *to feel that you do not belong in a situation or group*

BAND 8 STORY
In my new class everyone had studied at private schools, and I **felt out of place** with my village accent. Then a boy asked me to join his football game and the feeling melted away.

≈ **feel like an outsider** — o‘zini begona his qilmoq

≈ **not fit in** — mos kelmaslik

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi guruh yoki muhitda: feel out of place, odatda ‘at first’ bilan. Qarama-qarshi: fit in / feel at home. Past hissiyotni ko‘rsatadi.

Namuna gap: I **felt out of place** at the conference because I was easily the youngest person there.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

19 fall behind

6/10 SPEAKING BALL

ortda qolmoq • *to fail to keep the same speed or progress as others*

BAND 8 STORY
When I changed schools mid-year, I quickly **fell behind** in maths. The syllabus was different, so every evening my older brother explained the missing topics until I caught up.

≈ **lag behind** — orqada qolmoq

≈ **drop behind** — orqada qolib ketmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO
(to‘lov, ish) muddatidan kechikmoq — She **fell behind** with the rent after losing her job.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Fall behind (with / in + ot) o‘qish yoki ishda ortda qolishni bildiradi; qarshisi: catch up / keep up. Fe’lning o‘tgan shakli: fell behind.

Namuna gap: I was afraid I’d **fall behind** if I took even one day off.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

20 teething problems

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

boshlanishdagi kichik muammolar • *small difficulties at the start of something new*

BAND 8 STORY

Our new online system had a few **teething problems**. Passwords failed and pages froze, but the IT team fixed things within days and everything now runs smoothly.

≈ **initial hiccups** — boshlang‘ich qiyinchiliklar

≈ **early glitches** — dastlabki nosozliklar

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi tizim, ish yoki jarayonning boshidagi mayda muammolar: have / experience teething problems. Odatda ular tez hal bo‘ladi degan ma’no beradi.

Namuna gap: There were a few **teething problems** when I joined the team, but nothing serious.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Coping and adjusting

COLLOCATIONS 3 / 5

21 find my feet

10/10 SPEAKING BALL

oyoqqa turib olmoq, moslashib olmoq • *to become confident and comfortable in a new situation*

BAND 8 STORY

It took me about a month to **find my feet** in Tashkent. At first I got lost on the metro daily, but soon I knew every shortcut and even gave directions to tourists.

≈ **settle down** — joylashib olmoq

≈ **get my bearings** — yo'l-yo'riqni topib olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi joy yoki ish uchun: take time to find one's feet / begin to find one's feet. Qisqa vaqt oralig'ini ('after a few weeks') qo'shsangiz yaxshi.

Namuna gap: It took me a few weeks to **find my feet** in the new office.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

22 settle in

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

joylashib olmoq, o'rganib ketmoq • *to become comfortable in a new home, school or job*

BAND 8 STORY

The first week in the dormitory was noisy and chaotic, but I gradually **settled in**. I decorated my corner with family photos and soon it felt like a proper home.

≈ **settle down** — o'rnashib olmoq

≈ **get acclimatised** — iqlimga/muhitga moslashmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi uy, maktab yoki ish uchun: settle in; 'settle in to' + ot ham bo'ladi. Qisqa va kundalik, Part 1 da ham ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: The children **settled in** at their new school much faster than we expected.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

23 get the hang of

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ning uddasidan chiqa boshlamoq, o'rganib olmoq • *to learn how to do something properly after some practice*

BAND 8 STORY

Cooking for myself was a disaster at first, but after a week or two I **got the hang of** it. Now I make a decent plov, and my flatmates actually ask for seconds.

≈ **get used to** — ko'nikmoq

≈ **master the basics** — asoslarni egallamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi ko'nikma uchun: get the hang of + ot yoki -ing. Norasmiy, Part 1 va 2 uchun juda mos; 'at last / eventually' bilan ishlating.

Namuna gap: It took me a while to **get the hang of** the city's bus routes.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

24 get used to

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ga o‘rganib qolmoq, ko‘nikmoq • *to become familiar with something so it no longer feels strange*

BAND 8 STORY

I had to **get used to** waking up at five for my new job. The first week was brutal, but now I enjoy the quiet streets and a calm cup of tea before sunrise.

≈ **grow accustomed to** — o‘rganib qolmoq

≈ **become accustomed to** — ko‘nikib ketmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

Bu yerda ‘to‘ predlog: -ing shakli keladi — I’m still getting **used to** living on my own.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Muhim: get used to + ot yoki -ing (to — predlog!). ‘get used to eat’ xato. ‘used to + fe’l’ esa boshqa narsa: odat bo‘lgan.

Namuna gap: I slowly **got used to** the cold winters and even started enjoying the snow.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

25 ease into

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

asta-sekin kirishmoq • *to start something new slowly and gently*

BAND 8 STORY

My manager let me **ease into** the job by giving me small tasks in the first week. By the end of the month I was handling projects on my own and no longer felt nervous.

≈ **settle into** — asta o‘rnashmoq

≈ **start off gently** — ohista boshlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi ish yoki rejimga asta kirishda: ease into + ot / routine. Kuchli, tez o‘zgarishning aksi; yumshoq moslashuvni ta’kidlaydi.

Namuna gap: I tried to **ease into** the new schedule instead of changing everything overnight.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

26 take it in my stride

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

xotirjam, bemalol qabul qilmoq • *to deal with a difficulty calmly without getting upset*

BAND 8 STORY

Everyone expected me to panic when the lessons switched to online, but I **took it in my stride**. I bought a headset, set up a desk near the window and carried on as normal.

≈ **stay calm** — xotirjam bo‘lmoq

≈ **shrug it off** — e’tibor bermay qo‘ya qolmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qiyin yoki kutilmagan vaziyatga xotirjam munosabat: take something in one’s stride. Aksar ‘surprisingly well’ yoki ‘calmly’ bilan; Part 1 savollariga javobda ham ishlaydi.

Namuna gap: My sister **took** the move **in her stride**, while I was worrying about everything.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

27 rise to the challenge

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

qiyinchilikka munosib javob bermoq • *to deal successfully with something difficult*

BAND 8 STORY

When my teacher was ill, I had to lead the class project. I was terrified, but I **rose to the challenge**, divided the tasks fairly and we ended up with the highest mark.

≈ **step up to the plate** — mas'uliyatni o'z zimmasiga olmoq

≈ **meet the challenge** — qiyinchilikni yengmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ijobiy yakun yoki ma'qtov uchun: rise to the challenge (of + -ing). Odatda 'to my surprise' bilan o'zingizni maqtamasdan ishlatiladi.

Namuna gap: Faced with a completely new role, she **rose to the challenge** brilliantly.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

28 get into the swing of things

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ish ritmiga kirib olmoq • *to become comfortable with a new routine or activity*

BAND 8 STORY

The first two weeks of training were hectic, but once I **got into the swing of things**, the days flew by. I even started arriving early to enjoy a coffee with the team.

≈ **get into the rhythm** — ritmga kirmoq

≈ **get up to speed** — jarayondan xabardor bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Norasmiy; ish yoki o'qish boshlanganidan keyin: get into the swing of things. 'Eventually / after a while' bilan keladi, Part 1 uchun ham yaxshi.

Namuna gap: After a slow start, I **got into the swing of things** and began to enjoy university life.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

29 keep an open mind

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ochiq fikrlilikni saqlamoq • *to be ready to accept new ideas or ways of doing things*

BAND 8 STORY

Before I moved to Japan, my friends warned me about the strict rules. I decided to **keep an open mind**, and I'm glad I did, because the politeness there actually made life easier.

≈ **be open-minded** — ochiq fikrli bo'lmoq

≈ **stay receptive** — yangilikka ochiq bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Yangi madaniyat, fikr yoki usulga munosabatda: keep an open mind about / when + -ing. Part 3 da 'what helps people adapt' savollariga mos.

Namuna gap: The best advice is to **keep an open mind** and try everything at least once.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

30 lean on

7/10
SPEAKING BALL

...ga tayanmoq, yordam so‘ramoq • *to depend on someone for support when things are hard*

BAND 8 STORY

During my first term abroad, I **leaned on** my roommate heavily. She cooked with me, corrected my emails and listened when I felt lost, and today she’s one of my closest friends.

≈ **turn to** — murojaat qilmoq

≈ **rely on** — ishonmoq, suyanmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA’NO

(fe’l) suyanmoq, egilib turmoq — He **leaned on** the fence and watched the match.

Qachon ishlatiladi: Odamga ruhiy yoki amaliy tayanish: lean on + odam (for support). Ma’nosi ‘depend’ ga yaqin, lekin hissiyotli; Part 2 da yordam bergan insonni tasvirlashda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: When things got tough, I **leaned on** my family for advice and encouragement.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Looking back: results and reasons

COLLOCATIONS 4 / 5

31 come out stronger

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

yanada kuchli bo‘lib chiqmoq • *to become more confident after a difficult experience*

BAND 8 STORY

Looking back, those first months were hard, but I **came out stronger**. I learned to manage money, cook and solve problems alone, which makes me less afraid of the future.

≈ **emerge stronger** — yanada kuchayib chiqmoq

≈ **come through unscathed** — zarar ko‘rmay chiqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xulosa qismida: come out of something stronger / come out stronger. Qiyinchilikdan olingan ijobiy saboqni ko‘rsatadi, Part 2 yakuniga ajoyib.

Namuna gap: Overall, I **came out stronger** from the experience and a lot more independent.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

32 broaden my horizons

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

dunyoqarashimni kengaytirmoq • *to experience new things so that you understand more*

BAND 8 STORY

Living in another country really **broadened my horizons**. I met people from twelve countries, tried food I’d never heard of, and realised that my way of doing things wasn’t the only one.

≈ **expand my outlook** — dunyoqarashimni kengaytirmoq

≈ **open my eyes to** — ko‘zimni ochmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sayohat, o‘qish yoki yangi muhit foydasini aytganda: broaden one’s horizons (horizons ko‘plikda!). ‘broad my horizons’ xato, fe’l — broaden.

Namuna gap: Joining the exchange programme **broadened my horizons** more than any textbook could.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

33 boost my confidence

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

ishonchimni oshirmoq • *to make me feel more sure of myself*

BAND 8 STORY

Passing my first presentation in English really **boosted my confidence**. I stopped apologising for my accent, and soon I was volunteering to speak in every seminar.

≈ **build up my confidence** — ishonchimni mustahkamlamoq

≈ **give me a lift** — ruhimni ko‘tarmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Muvaffaqiyat natijasi haqida: boost / build (up) one’s confidence. Ot sifatida ‘a confidence boost’ ham tabiiy, Part 2 sabablarida foydali.

Namuna gap: Getting through the first week alone gave me a real **confidence boost**, so I took it as a sign.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

34 a blessing in disguise

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

yashirin baxt, ko‘rinishda yomon, aslida yaxshi narsa • *something that seems bad at first but turns out to be good*

BAND 8 STORY

Losing my old job felt like a disaster, but it turned out to be **a blessing in disguise**. It pushed me to retrain, and the new career suits me much better.

≈ **a silver lining** — har yomonlikda yaxshilik

≈ **a happy accident** — baxtli tasodif

Qachon ishlatiladi: Idiom: be / prove to be a blessing in disguise. Dastlab yomon ko‘ringan voqea yaxshi yakun topganida ishlating, asosan Part 2 xulosasida.

Namuna gap: Missing the earlier flight was **a blessing in disguise**, because I met my future flatmate at the airport.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

35 look back on

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

orqaga nazar tashlab eslamoq • *to think about a period of your past*

BAND 8 STORY

I **look back on** that tough first year with a smile now. It was lonely and exhausting, but it taught me more about myself than the previous eighteen years.

≈ **reflect on** — mulohaza yuritmoq

≈ **recall** — esga olmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Xotira va xulosalarni aytganda: look back on + ot (time / experience / period). ‘Looking back’ esa jumla boshida kirish iborasi bo‘ladi.

Namuna gap: When I **look back on** my childhood, the summers at my grandparents’ are what I remember.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

36 become second nature

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tabiatiga aylanmoq, avtomatik bo‘lib qolmoq • *to become so natural that you do it without thinking*

BAND 8 STORY

At first I had to remind myself to say hello to neighbours. After a few months it **became second nature**, and now I greet everyone in my building without even noticing.

≈ **come naturally** — tabiiy bo‘lmoq

≈ **become automatic** — avtomatik bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ko‘nikma yoki odat endi qiyin emasligini ko‘rsatishda: X becomes / is second nature (to me). ‘second nature’ dan oldin artikl ishlatilmaydi.

Namuna gap: Now, switching between three languages **is second nature** to me.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

37 bounce back

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

tezda o‘ziga kelmoq, tiklanmoq • *to recover quickly after a difficult time or failure*

BAND 8 STORY

After I failed my first IELTS attempt, I was upset for two days, but then I **bounced back**. I analysed my mistakes, rebooked the test, and scored a full band higher.

≈ **recover quickly** — tez tiklanmoq

≈ **get back on my feet** — qaddini rostlamoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Muvaffaqiyatsizlik yoki qiyinchilikdan keyin: bounce back (from + ot). Part 3 da ham: ‘resilient people bounce back faster’. Norasmiy-neytral.

Namuna gap: Children usually **bounce back** from change much faster than adults.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

38 build resilience

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

chidamlilikni shakllantirmoq • *to become better at dealing with difficulties and recovering*

BAND 8 STORY

Moving cities at sixteen helped me **build resilience**. Each time something went wrong, I had to solve it myself, and over time small problems stopped feeling so scary.

≈ **develop mental toughness** — ruhiy chidamlilikni rivojlantirmoq

≈ **toughen up** — chiniqmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Qiyinchiliklardan olingan foyda haqida: build / develop resilience. ‘resilience’ (ot) va ‘resilient’ (sifat) farqiga e’tibor bering; Part 3 uchun ham mos.

Namuna gap: Facing challenges early in life helps young people **build resilience**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

39 feel at home

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zini uyidagidek his qilmoq • *to feel comfortable and relaxed in a place*

BAND 8 STORY

After about three months, Tashkent finally began to **feel like home**. I had my favourite bakery, a regular seat on the metro, and a friend to wave at on the way to class.

≈ **feel comfortable** — o‘zini qulay his qilmoq

≈ **feel a sense of belonging** — qarashlilik hissini sezmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Moslashishning yakuniy bosqichi: feel at home / make oneself at home. Qarama-qarshi: feel out of place. ‘feel at home’ ni ‘feel like home’ bilan aralashtirmang.

Namuna gap: The host family was so welcoming that I **felt at home** within a day.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

40 grow as a person

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

shaxs sifatida o‘sib yetilmoq • *to become more mature and understand yourself better*

BAND 8 STORY

I think the whole experience helped me **grow as a person**. I became more patient with others, and I stopped complaining about small things that used to annoy me.

≈ **mature as a person** — ulg‘aymoq

≈ **develop personally** — shaxsan rivojlanmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tajribaning ichki foydasini aytishda: help someone grow as a person. ‘as a person’ ni qo‘shish iborani tabiiy va aniq qiladi, Part 2 xulosasi uchun mos.

Namuna gap: Taking responsibility at a young age made me **grow as a person**.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

41 adapt to

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ga moslashmoq • *to change your behaviour so you can deal with a new situation*

BAND 8 STORY
Younger people usually **adapt to** new technology much faster, because they have grown up with phones and apps. My grandfather needed a few patient lessons before he could video-call us.

≈ **adjust to** — moslashmoq

≈ **get accustomed to** — ko'nikmoq

BOSHQA FOYDALI MA'NO
(fe'l, ob'ekt) o'zgartirmoq, moslashtirmoq — The teacher **adapted** the book for younger students.

Qachon ishlatiladi: 'adapt to' dan keyin ot yoki -ing keladi (to — predlog). Part 3 ning asosiy fe'li; 'adjust to' sinonim, lekin 'adapt' ko'proq katta o'zgarishlarga tegishli.

Namuna gap: People who read widely tend to **adapt to** unfamiliar surroundings more easily.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

42 set in their ways

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'z odatidan qaytmaydigan, qotib qolgan • *unwilling to change habits or opinions, usually because of age*

BAND 8 STORY
My grandfather is completely **set in his ways**. He has had the same breakfast and walk every day for thirty years, and he politely refuses any new gadget we buy for him.

≈ **stuck in their ways** — o'z yo'lida qotib qolgan

≈ **old-fashioned** — eskicha fikrlaydigan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Keksa odamlar yoki odatidan qaytmaydigan kishilar haqida: be set in one's ways. Biroz salbiy yoki hazil ohangi bor, shuning uchun hurmat bilan ishlating.

Namuna gap: Many older employees are **set in their ways** and prefer the traditional methods.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

43 embrace change

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o'zgarishni mamnuniyat bilan qabul qilmoq • *to accept new things with enthusiasm*

BAND 8 STORY
The most successful people I know **embrace change** instead of fearing it. When our company moved online, my manager saw it as an opportunity and trained everyone in a week.

≈ **welcome change** — o'zgarishni qarshi olmoq

≈ **open up to new ideas** — yangi g'oyalarga ochiq bo'lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3 da fikr bildirishda ishlating: people who embrace change... Qarama-qarshisi: resist change. 'Embrace' — kuchli, ijobiy fe'l.

Namuna gap: Companies that **embrace change** usually survive longer in a fast-moving market.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

44 resistant to change

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

o‘zgarishga qarshi turadigan • *unwilling to accept new ideas or ways of working*

BAND 8 STORY

Some staff were **resistant to change** when the new software was introduced. They worried it would be harder, so the company ran friendly workshops and the complaints soon disappeared.

≈ **reluctant to change** — o‘zgarishga ikkilanadigan

≈ **averse to change** — o‘zgarishdan qochadigan

Qachon ishlatiladi: Sifat: be resistant to change (to + ot). ‘resist change’ fe’li ham mavjud. Odamlar yoki tashkilotlar haqida gapirganda Part 3 uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Employees are often **resistant to change** when nobody explains the reasons.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

45 a smooth transition

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

silliq, muammosiz o‘tish • *a change from one situation to another without major problems*

BAND 8 STORY

A short orientation week gave first-year students **a smooth transition** from school to university. Older students showed them the campus, which cut down on stress considerably.

≈ **a seamless handover** — uzluksiz o‘tish

≈ **an easy adjustment** — oson moslashuv

Qachon ishlatiladi: Maktabdan universitetga, ishdan ishga o‘tish haqida: make / ensure / have a smooth transition. ‘Transition from X to Y’ tuzilmasini yodda tuting.

Namuna gap: Mentoring programmes help newcomers make **a smooth transition** into the company.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

46 keep pace with

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

...bilan hamqadam bo‘lmoq • *to move or change at the same speed as something else*

BAND 8 STORY

Technology moves so fast that it’s hard to **keep pace with** every new app. I follow a few tech blogs, which helps me stay reasonably up to date without wasting hours.

≈ **keep up with** — ulgurmoq

≈ **stay abreast of** — yangiliklardan xabardor bo‘lmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Tez o‘zgaruvchan sohalar haqida: keep pace with + ot (technology / developments / changes). ‘keep up with’ dan biroz rasmiyroq, esse va Part 3 uchun mos.

Namuna gap: Schools must **keep pace with** the digital world if students are to find good jobs.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

47 on-the-job training

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

ish jarayonidagi o‘qitish • *learning practical skills while actually working*

BAND 8 STORY

Our company relies on **on-the-job training**. New employees shadow a senior colleague for a month, which is much more useful than watching videos or reading long manuals.

≈ **hands-on training** — amaliy o‘qitish

≈ **a mentoring scheme** — ustoz-shogird dasturi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 3: how can companies help employees adjust? Javobda: provide / offer on-the-job training. Ot sifatida, chiziqcha bilan yoziladi. Ish haqida yaxshi.

Namuna gap: Good **on-the-job training** helps staff adapt to new technology without much stress.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

48 a creature of habit

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

odatlariga sodiq inson • *a person who likes to do the same things in the same way*

BAND 8 STORY

I’m **a creature of habit**: I eat the same breakfast, take the same route to work, and sit in the same seat on the bus. So when my routine changes, I feel a bit lost.

≈ **a person of routine** — tartibga amal qiluvchi odam

≈ **love routine** — tartibni yaxshi ko‘rmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 1 savol ‘Do you like routines?’ ga javobda ajoyib: I’m a creature of habit. ‘a’ dan oldin artikl yo‘qolmasin; ko‘plikda: creatures of habit.

Namuna gap: My father is **a creature of habit** and sits in exactly the same chair every evening.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

49 move with the times

7/10 SPEAKING BALL

zamon bilan hamnafas bo‘lmoq • *to change your ideas or methods to match modern life*

BAND 8 STORY

My uncle’s little shop nearly closed because he refused to **move with the times**. When his daughter set up online ordering, sales doubled in a month and he grudgingly admitted she was right.

≈ **keep up with the times** — zamon bilan yurmoq

≈ **modernise** — zamonaviylashtirmoq

Qachon ishlatiladi: Biznes yoki an’ana haqida Part 3 da: businesses must move with the times. ‘with the times’ — doimiy ibora, ‘time’ emas.

Namuna gap: Schools that fail to **move with the times** risk losing their students.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

50 a sense of belonging

8/10
SPEAKING BALL

qarashlilik, o‘zini jamoaning bir qismi his qilish • *the feeling that you are accepted as part of a group*

BAND 8 STORY

Joining the football team gave me **a sense of belonging** in a city where I knew nobody. We ate together after every match, and gradually I stopped feeling like a visitor.

≈ **a feeling of acceptance** — qabul qilinganlik hissi

≈ **a sense of community** — jamoa hissi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Moslashuvning muhim omillarini aytishda: give someone a sense of belonging / feel a sense of belonging. Part 3 da jamiyat va do‘stlik haqida ham juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: A warm welcome gives newcomers **a sense of belonging** from day one.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

Describe and explain

1 What I found hardest was ... (that)

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Menga eng qiyini ... bo‘ldi • *a cleft sentence that puts the main difficulty first*

BAND 8 STORY

What I found hardest was the silence in the evenings. Back home there were always cousins around, but in my little flat I could hear the fridge hum, so I started calling friends every night.

≈ **The thing I struggled with most was...** — Eng qiynalgan narsam...

≈ **What really got to me was...** — Meni eng ko‘p bezovta qilgani...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Part 2 dagi ‘what was difficult’ bandi uchun: What I found hardest/most challenging + was + ot yoki ‘that’ gap. ‘was’ dan keyin to‘liq gap kelsa ‘that’ kerak.

Namuna gap: **What I found hardest was** being away from my family during holidays.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

2 It took me + time + to + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Menga ... qilish uchun ... vaqt ketdi • *shows how long a change or process lasted*

BAND 8 STORY

It took me nearly three months **to** feel normal in my new school. I ate lunch alone for weeks, but then a classmate asked about my drawing, and from that day the loneliness faded.

≈ **I needed + time + to V** — ... uchun ... vaqt kerak bo‘ldi

≈ **After + time, I finally...** — ... dan keyin nihoyat...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Moslashish vaqtini aytishda juda foydali: It took me + davr + to + fe’l. ‘It took me to feel’ emas, davr (three weeks) albatta bo‘lsin.

Namuna gap: **It took me** about a week **to** get used to the noise of the city.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

3 The more ..., the more ...

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Qanchalik ko‘p ..., shunchalik ko‘proq ... • *a double comparative showing two things change together*

BAND 8 STORY

The more I practised speaking, **the more** confident I became. At first I whispered in class, but after a month of daily conversations I was giving short talks without notes.

≈ **The longer ..., the easier ...** — Qancha uzoq ..., shuncha oson...

≈ **As + S + V, S + V more** — ...gan sari...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki o‘zgarish bog‘liqligini aytishda: The + qiyosiy daraja + gap, the + qiyosiy daraja + gap. Ikkala bo‘lakda ham ‘the’ bo‘lishi shart. Part 3 da sabab-oqibat uchun yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **The more** time I spent with locals, **the easier** the language became.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

4 so + adj + that / such + noun + that

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

shu qadar ...ki... • *explains a result by showing something was extreme*

BAND 8 STORY

The workload was **so** heavy **that** I had no energy left for anything else. I slept on the bus, but after I made a weekly timetable, the days became far more manageable.

≈ **It was such + noun + that...** — Shunday ... ediki...

≈ **to the extent that...** — shu darajadaki...

Qachon ishlatiladi: So + sifat, such + (sifat) + ot: so heavy / such a heavy workload. Ortiqcha 'very so' demang. Natija ('that' bo'lagi) qiyinchilikni ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: The culture was **so** different **that** I laughed at my own mistakes every day.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

5 Not only did + S + V, but + S also + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

nafaqat ... balki ... • *inversion for adding a second surprising point*

BAND 8 STORY

Not only did the move **teach** me independence, **but** it **also** showed me how kind strangers can be. A neighbour I'd never met brought me soup when I was sick, which I'll never forget.

≈ **Not only ... but also...** — nafaqat ... balki ...

≈ **As well as + -ing, ...** — ...dan tashqari...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Gap boshida 'Not only' kelsa, yordamchi fe'l oldinga chiqadi: Not only did I..., Not only was it... Rasmiy va kuchli; Part 2 va 3 da 1-2 marta xolos.

Namuna gap: **Not only did** the course **improve** my English, **but** it **also** made me more adaptable.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

6 the place in which / with whom + S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...gan joy, ...gan odam (predlogli sifatdosh gap) • *a relative clause with a preposition before which/whom*

BAND 8 STORY

Tashkent is **the city in which** I had to rebuild my whole life. The people **with whom** I shared the flat became like family, and they made the process so much gentler.

≈ **the place where...** — ...gan joy

≈ **the person (whom) I lived with** — birga yashagan odam

Qachon ishlatiladi: Rasmiy uslub: predlog + which/whom: the city in which I lived; the friends with whom I... Kundalik nutqda predlog oxirida ham bo'ladi, lekin bu variant Band 8 ga yaxshi.

Namuna gap: This is **the neighbourhood in which** I finally felt at home.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

7 Hardly had + S + p.p. when + S + V (past)

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ulgurmasdan... • *shows one event happened immediately after another*

BAND 8 STORY

Hardly had I **unpacked** my suitcase **when** the lights went out in the whole dormitory. We all stood in the dark corridor laughing, and that's how I met half my future friends.

≈ **No sooner had ... than ...** — ...ulgurmay ...

≈ **As soon as...** — ...bilanoq...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Inversiya: Hardly had + ega + o'tgan tugagan zamon + when. 'when' bilan (than emas — u 'No sooner' ga tegishli). Hikoyada birdan sodir bo'lgan voqeani aytganda juda yaxshi.

Namuna gap: **Hardly had** I **arrived when** I was asked to give a short presentation.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

8 Having + p.p., S + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ganidan keyin, ... • *a participle clause showing one action finished before another*

BAND 8 STORY

Having spent a month on my own, I finally stopped feeling nervous in the city. I'd learned the bus routes, found a cheap market and realised that asking for help is not a weakness.

≈ **After + -ing, S + V** — ...dan keyin

≈ **Once I had + p.p., ...** — ...ganimdan keyin...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Ikki gapning ega bir xil bo'lsa: Having + p.p. + vergul + ega. 'Having + ot' demang. Part 2 hikoyasida voqealar ketma-ketligini silliq ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **Having lived** abroad for a year, I find change far less intimidating.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

9 Had I + p.p., I would have + p.p.

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

Agar ... bo'lganimda, ... bo'lardi • *a third-conditional inversion for imagined past situations*

BAND 8 STORY

Had I known how hard the first week would be, **I would have** prepared more. I'd have learned basic phrases, but being thrown in at the deep end also taught me to improvise.

≈ **If I had + p.p., I would have...** — Agar ... bo'lganimda ...

≈ **If it hadn't been for...** — Agar ... bo'lmaganida...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Uchinchi shartli gapning 'if'siz varianti: Had + ega + p.p., ega + would have + p.p. Rasmiy, o'tmishdagi xato yoki afsus haqida gapirganda ishlating.

Namuna gap: **Had I joined** the club earlier, **I would have made** friends much sooner.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

10 Were it not for + noun, S + would + V

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

...bo'lmaganida, ... bo'lardi • *a conditional inversion for saying something depends on a person or thing*

BAND 8 STORY

Were it not for my roommate's patience, I'd have gone home after a month. She explained everything slowly and never made me feel stupid, so I stayed and thrived.

≈ **If it weren't for...** — ...bo'lmaganida...

≈ **But for + noun, ...** — ...bo'lmasa edi...

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hozirgi yoki umumiy holat uchun: Were it not for + ot, ega + would + fe'l; o'tmishda: Had it not been for. Kimningdir yordamiga minnatdorchilikni ko'rsatadi.

Namuna gap: **Were it not for** my teacher's encouragement, I'd still be afraid of speaking English.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

11 Looking back, I wish I had + p.p.

8/10 SPEAKING BALL

Orqaga qarasam, ... bo'lganida edi • *regret about the past using wish + past perfect*

BAND 8 STORY

Looking back, I wish I had asked for help sooner. I wasted weeks trying to cope alone, when a simple message to my supervisor would have solved my biggest problems.

≈ **If only I had + p.p.** — Kashki ... qilganimda edi

≈ **I should have + p.p.** — Qilishim kerak edi

Qachon ishlatiladi: Afsus: wish + had + p.p. (o'tmish); hozirgi afsus uchun wish + o'tgan zamon. 'wish I would have' — xato. Reflection ('Looking back') bilan boshlash Band 8 ga mos.

Namuna gap: **I wish I had** been braver about speaking in my first month abroad.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

12 Little did I know that + S + would + V

9/10 SPEAKING BALL

...ekanini bilmagan edim • *inversion for building drama about a future surprise*

BAND 8 STORY

Little did I know that the dormitory I dreaded would become my favourite place. The thin walls and noisy corridors turned into friendships, and I still miss those late-night tea sessions.

≈ **Never would I have guessed (that)...** — Hech o'ylamagan edim...

≈ **I had no idea that...** — ... ekanini bilmagan edim

Qachon ishlatiladi: Hikoyadagi burilish uchun: Little did I know + (that) + would + fe'l. Faqat o'tmish hikoyada; 'Little did I knew' xato. Haddan ko'p ishlatmang.

Namuna gap: **Little did I know** my first awkward chat would lead to a lifelong friendship.

SIZNING NAVBATINGIZ — 2 TA GAP YOZING

SAMPLE CUE CARD

Describe a time you had to adapt to something new.

Describe a time you had to adapt to something new.

You should say:

- what it was
- why you had to adapt
- what was difficult
- how you coped

My 1-minute notes

- moved to Tashkent • age eighteen • university
- family decision • better courses • dormitory
- homesick • noisy dorm • fast lectures
- language and accents • struggled to keep up
- roommate help • routine • study group
- three months • found my feet • more independent

SAMPLE ANSWER • BAND 8

I • Intro (what)	I'd like to talk about the time I moved from my small hometown to Tashkent at the age of eighteen to study at university. It was the first time I'd ever lived away from my family, so it meant adapting to a completely new way of life almost overnight.
P • Why I had to adapt	As for the reason, it wasn't really a choice. The course I wanted was only offered in the capital, and my parents encouraged me to take the plunge because it would open doors for my future. So, one September morning, I found myself stepping off the train with two heavy suitcases and a very nervous stomach.
P • What was difficult	When it comes to the difficult part, there were several things. What I found hardest was the loneliness in the first weeks. I got homesick every evening, and the noisy dormitory only made it worse. On top of that, the lectures moved at lightning speed, and I struggled to keep up. Hardly had I got used to one routine when another new demand appeared.
E • Reason 1 (how I coped)	Luckily, I found ways to cope. My roommate turned out to be a lifesaver, because she explained how the city worked and invited me to a study group. Having built a daily routine, I stopped feeling so overwhelmed, and calling my mother every night helped me stay calm.
E • Reason 2 (result)	It took me about three months to find my feet, and the more I got involved, the more confident I became. Looking back, I realise it was a blessing in disguise, because it forced me to step out of my comfort zone and become far more independent.
W • Wrap-up	So, all in all, adapting to life in Tashkent was a steep learning curve, but I came out stronger. It broadened my horizons and taught me that I'm much tougher than I imagined, which is something I'm really grateful for.

UPGRADE YOUR TALK

Tell a story, not a list

Instead of…	Say…
get used to something new	get the hang of it / find my feet
it was very hard	it was a steep learning curve
I was nervous	I felt out of my comfort zone
I felt sad without my family	I got really homesick
I felt strange there	I felt like a fish out of water
I became better after some time	I came out stronger
it was good for me	it was a blessing in disguise
try something new bravely	take the plunge
a new culture feels strange	culture shock
begin again	start from scratch
a new, unknown area	uncharted territory
scary to think about	a daunting prospect
it made me tired	it took its toll on me
I couldn't follow	struggle to keep up
difficulty with language	a language barrier
a bad period	hit a rough patch
I took on too much	bite off more than I can chew
small early problems	teething problems
get comfortable slowly	ease into
accept calmly	take it in my stride
handle the challenge	rise to the challenge
get used to the routine	get into the swing of things
be ready to accept	keep an open mind
ask for support	lean on
no longer need to think	become second nature